The Attic — Custom MERN E-commerce + AI Proposal

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Executive summary

We propose replacing The Attic's WooCommerce + Elementor site with a custom MERN platform built around one idea: **let customers see, customise and trust a solid-wood piece before they pay ₹15,000 to ₹80,000 for it.**

The Attic is not a reseller. It manufactures solid sheesham and mango wood furniture in Jodhpur, already sells on Amazon and Flipkart, and takes customisation requests by phone and WhatsApp. A plugin-based template cannot turn those strengths into a buying experience. A custom platform can.

The proposal has three layers:

1. **A faster, owned storefront** with a real furniture configurator, room-fit checks, pincode-aware delivery and assembly, and an admin built for a manufacturer, not a blog.
2. **An AI layer** that sells like The Attic's best showroom staff: a design consultant that sees the customer's room, "See it in your room" visualisation, photo-to-product search, and AI that writes listings and answers WhatsApp queries.
3. **One control room** for the website, Amazon, Flipkart, WhatsApp and the factory floor, so stock, orders and custom jobs live in one place.

The headline outcomes we target are higher conversion on high-ticket items, fewer returns from "it looked different" or "it didn't fit", more direct (commission-free) sales versus marketplaces, and less manual work for the sales team.

Where The Attic is today

The current site sells well-made products through a generic template, and most of what makes The Attic special happens offline. Based on a review of theattic.co.in on 17 Oct 2026:

Area	What we see today	Gap a custom build closes
Platform	WordPress + WooCommerce + Elementor page builder, many plugins	Plugin bloat slows pages and makes changes risky
Catalogue	Sideboards, TV cabinets, coffee and end tables, dining sets, beds, wardrobes, cane furniture, LED mirrors	No filters by room size, wood type, finish or dimensions
Pricing	Mostly ₹7,000 to ₹80,000; heavy discounts (9% to 39% off) and a site-wide coupon	No personalised offers; same discount for everyone
Customisation	"Customize your furniture" handled by a phone helpline	No online configurator; leads lost outside office hours (10:00 to 18:30)
Delivery and assembly	Free shipping; assembly only in serviceable pincodes listed on a separate page	Customer cannot check delivery date or assembly on the product page
Channels	Also sells on Amazon and Flipkart; WhatsApp chat button	Stock, orders and reviews managed separately per channel
Trust	117 Google reviews in a carousel; testimonials mention colour looking darker and width concerns	Reviews not tied to products; no way to preview colour or fit at home
Product names	Long, SEO-stuffed titles copied across channels	Hard to read; no structured specs for comparison

The testimonials tell the story: buyers love the quality but worry about **colour, size, delivery of heavy items and assembly**. Every feature below targets one of these four worries.

Core platform upgrades (non-AI)

These features alone justify the move off WooCommerce; most need heavy custom plugin work or are not possible there.

Storefront and shopping

- **Live furniture configurator.** Pick wood (sheesham, mango, acacia), finish (teak matte, honey, walnut), size and hardware; price, delivery time and preview update instantly. Replaces the phone-only "customise" flow and captures the order online.
- **Smart filters for furniture.** Filter by room, dimensions (fits a 6 ft wall), wood, finish, seating capacity, assembly needed or not, and delivery time to my pincode.
- **Pincode intelligence on every product.** Enter a pincode once to see delivery date, whether free assembly is available and whether the item fits a lift or staircase (from carton dimensions).
- **Room bundles and "complete the look".** Sell matching sets (Carlston TV cabinet + sideboard + coffee table) with a bundle discount.
- **360° spin and close-up grain zoom** so buyers see the real wood texture and finish.
- **Fabric and finish swatch kit.** Order physical wood-finish samples for a small refundable fee, credited on purchase.
- **Flexible payments.** UPI, cards, no-cost EMI, Buy Now Pay Later, partial COD and a "pay 20% now, rest on delivery" option for made-to-order pieces.
- **Progressive Web App.** Installs like an app, works on weak mobile networks, sends push offers.

Post-purchase experience

- **Live order tracker with factory stages:** order confirmed → wood selected → crafting → polishing → quality check → shipped → assembly booked. Photos from the factory at key stages.
- **Assembly and service booking:** customer picks an assembly slot; carpenter gets the job on a mobile panel.
- **Damage claim in 2 minutes:** upload photos, choose replacement or repair, track the claim.
- **Furniture care reminders:** polish and maintenance reminders on WhatsApp at 6 and 12 months, with care-kit upsell.
- **Verified reviews with customer room photos**, shown on each product page.

Admin, operations and growth

- **Manufacturer admin:** custom orders become production job cards with wood, finish, size and due date.

- **Omnichannel inventory:** one stock count synced to Amazon and Flipkart, so no overselling.
- **B2B / bulk portal:** separate pricing and quotes for interior designers, hotels, cafés and offices.
- **Role-based access** for sales, factory, logistics and accounts.
- **Dashboards:** revenue by channel, top products, abandoned carts, return reasons, custom-order pipeline.
- **Loyalty and referral programme:** points per purchase; referral credit (the testimonials show buyers already refer friends).
- **Built-in SEO:** server-rendered pages, clean product URLs, structured data for Google Shopping, fast Core Web Vitals.
- **Marketing automation:** abandoned-cart and price-drop alerts on WhatsApp, email and SMS.

AI feature suite

The AI is aimed at the four buying worries (colour, size, delivery, assembly) and at the team's manual work, not at gimmicks. Each feature below is buildable today with commercial vision and language models plus The Attic's own catalogue data.

For customers

AI feature	What the customer does	Why it matters for The Attic
AI Interior Consultant	Chats in English or Hindi: "Need a TV unit for a 10x12 living room, warm wood, under ₹20k" and gets 3 picks with reasons	Replaces the phone helpline after hours; sells 24x7
Snap Your Room	Uploads a room photo; AI detects wall colour, floor, style and free space, then recommends pieces that match	Solves "will it suit my home?"

AI feature	What the customer does	Why it matters for The Attic
See It In Your Room	Places the chosen piece into the customer's own photo at true scale and finish; mobile AR view on supported phones	Cuts "looked darker than expected" returns
Fit Check	Customer enters or measures wall and door widths; AI flags if the piece fits the space, doorway and lift	Cuts "didn't fit" returns on beds, wardrobes, dining sets
Visual Search	Uploads a Pinterest or Instagram screenshot; gets the closest Attic products	Captures inspiration-driven buyers
AI Custom Design Studio	Describes a dream piece ("sheesham bookshelf with cane doors, 5 ft"); AI generates a concept render and a draft quote for the factory to confirm	Turns customisation into an online, trackable lead
Voice and vernacular search	Searches by voice in Hindi, Tamil, Kannada and more	Reaches tier-2 and tier-3 buyers
Smart recommendations	Personalised home feed, "completes your room" suggestions and bundles	Raises order value
Review summariser	Sees a short AI summary of all reviews per product (quality, packaging, assembly)	Builds trust faster

For The Attic's team

- **AI listing writer:** from product photos and a spec sheet, generates a clean title, description, SEO tags and separate versions for Amazon, Flipkart and the website.
- **AI lifestyle photos:** turns a white-background factory shot into styled room images, saving photoshoot cost per new SKU.
- **WhatsApp AI sales agent:** answers price, stock, delivery and order-status questions, shares product cards and hands complex leads to a human.

- **Dynamic offer engine:** suggests discounts per product and customer segment instead of one site-wide coupon, protecting margins.
- **Demand forecasting:** predicts which designs and finishes will sell per city and season (festive, wedding season) so the factory plans wood and production.
- **Return and fraud risk scoring:** flags high-risk COD orders and likely returns before dispatch.
- **Review and sentiment insights:** reads reviews from the site, Google, Amazon and Flipkart and reports recurring issues (finish, packaging, a specific courier).
- **Business copilot for the owner:** ask "Which product lost sales in Bangalore last month and why?" in plain language and get an answer from live data.

Signature features to demo in the pitch

These five are what we recommend showing live in a clickable prototype; together they are rare among Indian solid-wood furniture sites.

1. **"Design My Room" in 60 seconds.** Customer uploads a living-room photo, AI reads the space and style, places a matching Attic TV cabinet, coffee table and sideboard into the photo at real scale, and shows one bundle price with delivery date. One flow covers consultation, visualisation, fit and checkout.
2. **Made-for-You Studio.** The customer describes or sketches a custom piece, sees an AI concept render in a chosen wood and finish, gets an instant estimate, and pays a booking amount. The factory receives a job card. This turns The Attic's manufacturing advantage into a feature no reseller can copy.
3. **Craft Story and Wood Passport.** Each order gets a QR-linked page showing the artisan team in Jodhpur, wood source, finish process and factory photos of that exact piece, plus care instructions and warranty. It builds emotional value and justifies price (a testimonial mentions "price point a bit high").
4. **WhatsApp Shopping Concierge.** The full catalogue, AI advice, order tracking, assembly booking and payment links inside WhatsApp, where Indian buyers already talk to The Attic.
5. **Owner's AI Copilot.** A dashboard where the owner asks questions in Hindi or English and gets answers across website, Amazon and Flipkart sales, stock and factory workload.

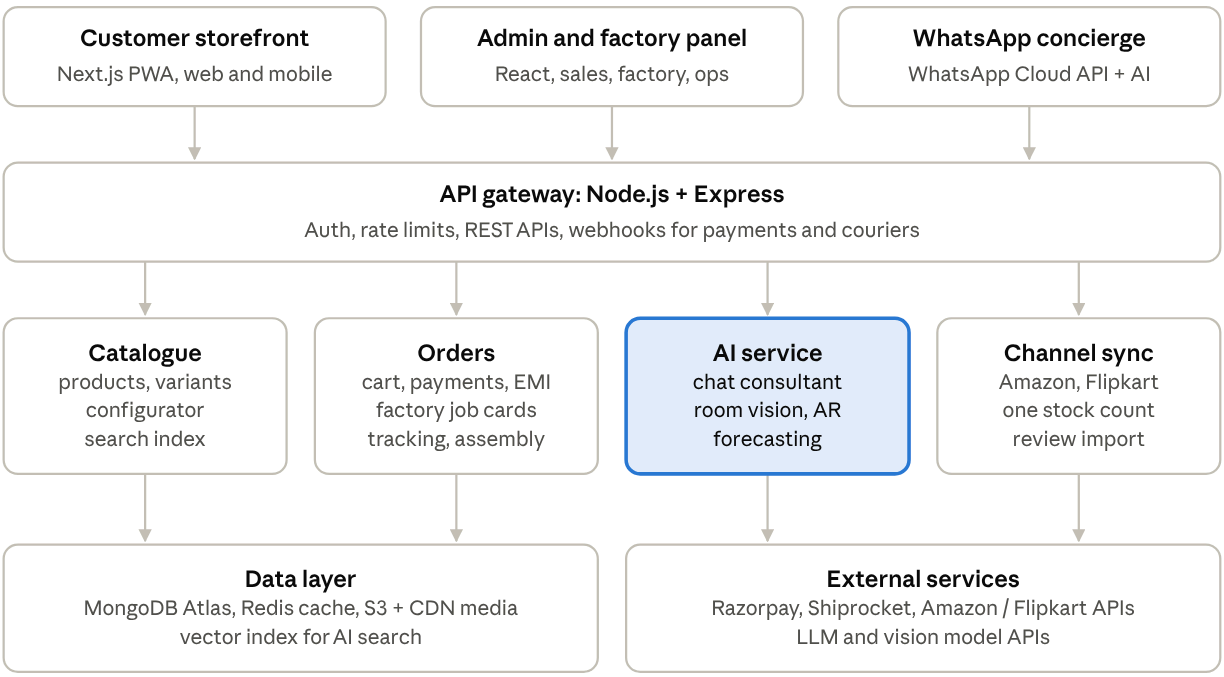
WooCommerce today vs the proposed platform

Capability	Current WooCommerce site	Proposed MERN + AI platform
Page speed	Theme and plugin heavy; slower on mobile	Server-rendered Next.js + CDN; target under 2 s load on 4G
Customisation	Phone helpline only	Online configurator + AI Custom Design Studio
Visualisation	Product photos	360° view, AI room placement, AR
Size confidence	Dimensions in text	AI Fit Check for space, doorway and lift
Search	Keyword search	AI chat, visual, voice and vernacular search
Delivery info	Separate pincode page	Delivery date and assembly on every product
Order tracking	Basic order status	Factory-stage tracker with photos
Marketplaces	Managed separately	One inventory and order hub for Amazon and Flipkart
WhatsApp	Chat button	AI sales and support agent with catalogue and payments
Discounts	One coupon for all	AI-driven personalised offers
Content	Manual listings and photoshoots	AI listing writer and lifestyle image generator
Insights	Plugin reports	Owner's AI copilot and demand forecasting
Ownership	Dependent on plugin updates and licences	Fully owned code, scales with the business

Technical architecture

The platform runs on the MERN stack (MongoDB, Express, React, Node.js), with Next.js for fast, SEO-friendly pages and a separate AI service so models can be swapped without touching the store.

One MERN backend serves the store, the team and WhatsApp



platform architecture · 3 front ends, 1 API, 4 services

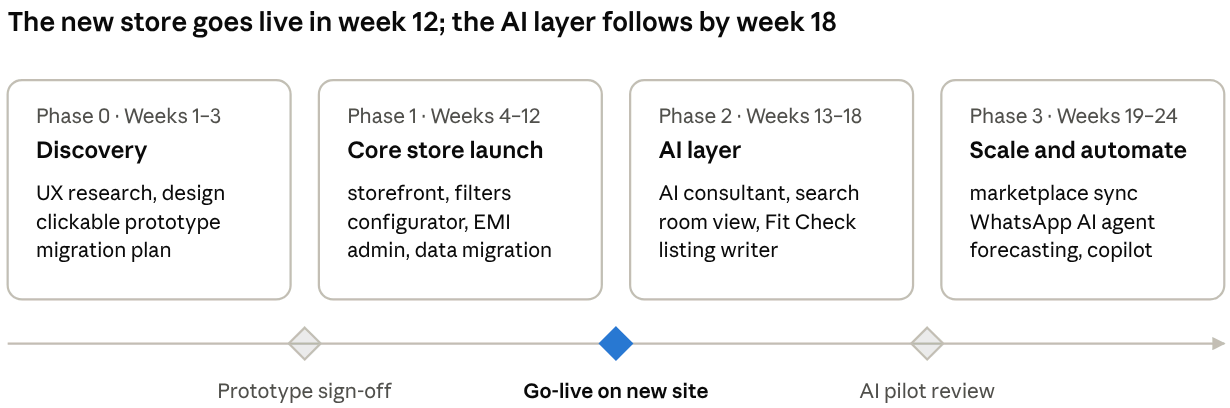
All three front ends call one API; the AI service is the only part that talks to model providers, which keeps costs and customer data under control.

Layer	Choice
Frontend	Next.js (React), Tailwind CSS, Three.js / model-viewer for 3D and AR
Backend	Node.js, Express, REST + webhooks, BullMQ job queues
Database	MongoDB Atlas with Atlas Vector Search, Redis cache
AI	Commercial LLM and vision APIs, image generation for room renders and lifestyle photos

Layer	Choice
Payments and logistics	Razorpay (UPI, cards, EMI), Shiprocket or Delhivery
Messaging	WhatsApp Cloud API, email and SMS gateway
Hosting	AWS or DigitalOcean with CDN, CI/CD, daily backups, SSL

Phased roadmap

We deliver in four phases over about 24 weeks, so The Attic gets a faster store first and AI features on top of real data. Final timeline is fixed after discovery.



indicative roadmap · 4 phases, 24 weeks, 3 gates

The old WooCommerce site stays live until go-live, with 301 redirects for every product and category URL so Google rankings carry over.

Business impact and next steps

We will agree measurable targets with The Attic during discovery, using their current analytics as the baseline. The metrics we will track:

Goal	Metric to track	Features that drive it
Sell more online	Conversion rate on products above ₹15,000	Room visualisation, Fit Check, AI consultant, EMI

Goal	Metric to track	Features that drive it
Fewer returns	Returns tagged colour or size mismatch	See It In Your Room, Fit Check, swatch kit
Higher order value	Average order value, bundle share	Complete the look, AI recommendations
Less marketplace commission	Share of revenue from own website	Loyalty, WhatsApp concierge, Wood Passport
Capture custom demand	Custom-order leads and closures per month	Configurator, Made-for-You Studio
Save team time	Hours per week on listings, queries and stock sync	AI listing writer, WhatsApp agent, omnichannel hub

Why our team

- One codebase we fully hand over, with documentation and training.
- AI features designed around The Attic's own data and customers, not a generic chatbot.
- Phased delivery so the business sees results from the first release.
- Post-launch support, monitoring and monthly AI improvement.

Proposed next steps

- [ ] 60-minute discovery call with the owner and sales lead
- [ ] Access to WooCommerce analytics, order data and Amazon / Flipkart seller reports
- [ ] We deliver a clickable prototype of "Design My Room" and the configurator
- [ ] Final scope, timeline and commercial proposal